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The Nazi regime imprisoned millions in thousands of sites across Europe, using these facilities to exploit forced labor, detain political opponents, and carry out mass genocide. Millions died from starvation, exhaustion, and deliberate murder. YouTube · United States Holocaust Me... +1

The camp system featured multiple classifications, outlined below.

Extermination / Death Camps

Designed specifically for mass murder, these facilities were equipped with gas chambers. Almost everyone sent to these sites was Jewish. Holocaust Encyclopedia +2

- **Auschwitz-Birkenau:** Operated as both a concentration/forced-labor camp and the largest killing center, where over 1.1 million people were murdered.
- **Treblinka:** A death camp where nearly 1 million people were murdered.
- **Belzec:** An extermination camp that operated primarily in 1942.
- **Sobibor:** An extermination camp built solely for the purpose of killing.
- **Chełmno:** The first killing center where the Nazis used gas vans to murder victims.
- **Majdanek:** Functioned as a large forced-labor/concentration camp alongside a killing center. Holocaust Encyclopedia +3

Concentration Camps

Established to incarcerate political prisoners, resistance groups, and individuals deemed racially or socially "inferior". While their primary purpose was forced labor and exploitation, the conditions caused mass death. The National WWII Museum | New Orle... +3

- **Dachau:** The first concentration camp (opened in 1933) and the principal site for imprisoned Catholic clergy.
- **Buchenwald:** Held over 200,000 prisoners over its lifetime, heavily relying on hundreds of subcamps for forced labor.
- **Mauthausen:** Known for brutal conditions in stone quarries and the presence of numerous subcamps.
- **Sachsenhausen:** Established near Berlin in 1936, it held political opponents and prisoners of war.

- **Ravensbrück:** The largest concentration camp established specifically for women. 🌟 JewishGen +4

Transit & Internment Camps

Facilities like **Westerbork**, **Drancy**, and **Gurs** were used as temporary collection points. Prisoners were held here before being deported by rail to killing centers in occupied Poland. 🌐 Holocaust Encyclopedia

Liberation & Legacy

By the time Allied forces liberated the camps in 1945, they uncovered horrors that prompted leaders like General Dwight D. Eisenhower to mandate documentation so the world would never deny the atrocities. 🌐 The National WWII Museum | New Orle... +1

For comprehensive historical records, maps, and lists of the camps, visit the [Holocaust Encyclopedia](#) or explore the [Records Relating to Nazi Concentration Camps](#) provided by the National Archives. You can also review detailed overviews via [The National WWII Museum](#).



11 sites

Nazi Camps | Holocaust Encyclopedia

May 28, 2025 — Killing centers (also referred to as "extermination camps" or "death camps") were designed to carry out genocide. Between 1941 and...



Holocaust Encyclopedia

The List of the Camps - JewishGen

* Bergen-Belsen (probably 2 sub-camps but location is unknown) * Börgermoor (no sub-camp known) * Buchenwald (174 sub-camps and e...



JewishGen

The Nazi Concentration Camp System | New Orleans

Apr 22, 2025 — In the Nazi camp system, no camps have commanded great historical attention than the so-called Vernichtungslager (extermination ca...



The National WWII Museum | New ...

Auschwitz-Birkenau

KL Auschwitz was the largest of the German Nazi concentration camps and extermination centers. Over 1.1 million men, women and chi...

center for human memory, history and crime

 Auschwitz-Birkenau

Liberation of Concentration Camps - The National WWII Museum

Fierce firefights occurred as U.S. troops approached. Near the camp, they found a death train with hundreds of corpses, and other ...



 The National WWII Museum | New ...

What Were Camps in the Holocaust? | Holocaust Explainer

Jul 30, 2025 — from Adolf Hitler's rise to power in 1933. until the end of World War II in 1945. the Nazis imprisoned millions of people in tens ...



 YouTube · United States Holocaust ...

Show all

AI can make mistakes, so double-check responses

Ask anything



Holocaust Encyclopedia

<https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org> › content › article › nazi... ⋮

Nazi Camps | Holocaust Encyclopedia

May 28, 2025 — Millions of people were imprisoned in **Nazi camps** during **World War II**. 2. The **Nazis** used several types of **camps** in the process of carrying out ...



Wikipedia

<https://en.wikipedia.org> › wiki › Nazi_concentration_ca... ⋮

Nazi concentration camps

Nazi Germany built and operated a system of **concentration camps** (**German**: Konzentrationslager) between 1933 and 1945. There were more than a thousand, ...

History

Organization

Forced labor

Statistics



The National WWII Museum | New Orleans
<https://www.nationalww2museum.org> › war › articles

The Nazi Concentration Camp System

Apr 22, 2025 — The **Nazi Concentration Camp** System. The **Nazis** created at least 44,000 camps, including ghettos and other sites of incarceration, between 1933 ...



JewishGen
<https://www.jewishgen.org> › general › listeeng

The List of the Camps

Following the Atlas of the **Holocaust** by Martin Gilbert, thousands of jews were sent to these **camps** by the French pro-**nazi** government of Petain: Abadla; Ain ...

Videos



4:42

What Were Camps in the Holocaust? | Holocaust Explainer

YouTube · United States Holocaust Memorial Museum
 Jul 30, 2025

6 key moments in this video ▾



3:44

What Was Auschwitz? | Holocaust Explainer

YouTube · United States Holocaust Memorial Museum
 Jan 26, 2026



49:12

Inside Nazi Death Camps: The Evolution of a Genocidal ...

YouTube · SLICE History
 Aug 18, 2024

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<https://khc.qcc.cuny.edu/camps>

Inside the Nazi System of Incarceration and Genocide

Approximately 44,000 **concentration camps** and ghettos existed across **Nazi**-occupied Europe and North Africa during **World War II**. These incarceration sites ...



Auschwitz-Birkenau

<https://www.auschwitz.org> > ...

Auschwitz-Birkenau

KL Auschwitz was the largest of the **German Nazi concentration camps** and extermination centers. ... **Holocaust** and the experience of prisoners. more.



BBC

<https://www.bbc.com/news/world-europe-50743973>

Auschwitz: How death camp became centre of Nazi ...

Jan 27, 2025 — What was the **Holocaust**? When the **Nazis** came to power in Germany in 1933 they began to strip Jewish people of all property, ...

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